4th **The Fourth Sheet**

Your accountant gives you three sheets. I give you the fourth.

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Sample Advisory Pty Ltd

A Brisbane finance and operations consultancy: projects billed on milestones, monthly retainers and training. 6 consultants, 3 management and admin staff.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

The fourth sheet: September 2026 vs August 2026

Consultant utilisation, September
76.2%
▲ from 72.6% in Aug

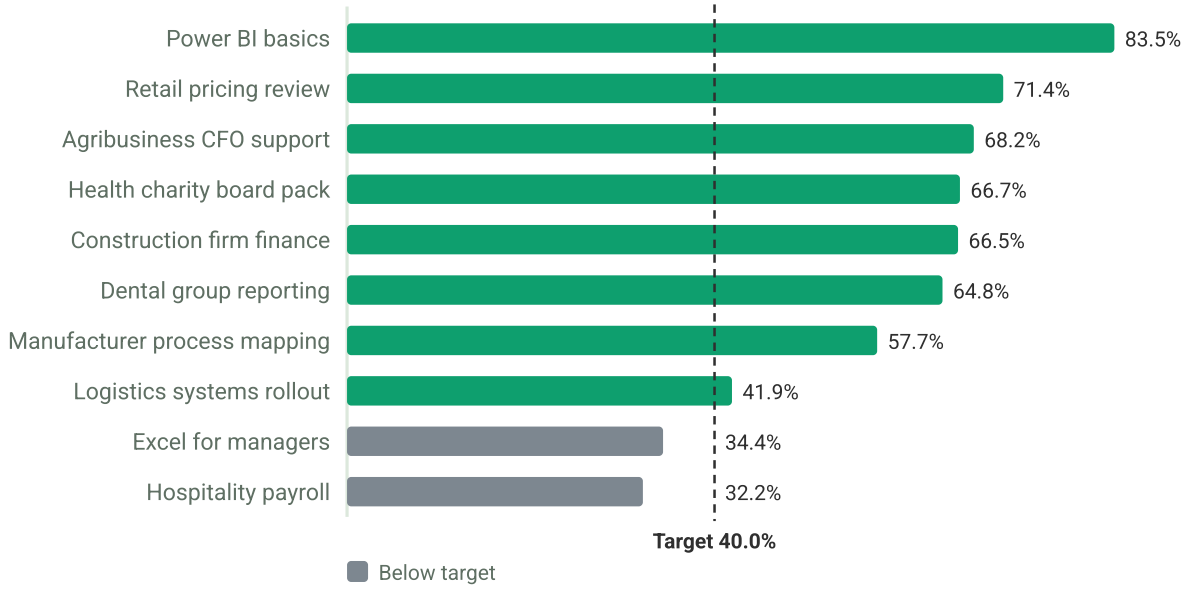
Revenue per billable hour
$190
▼ from $191 in Aug

Unbilled work + unpaid invoices
$251,402
▲ from $172,405 in Aug

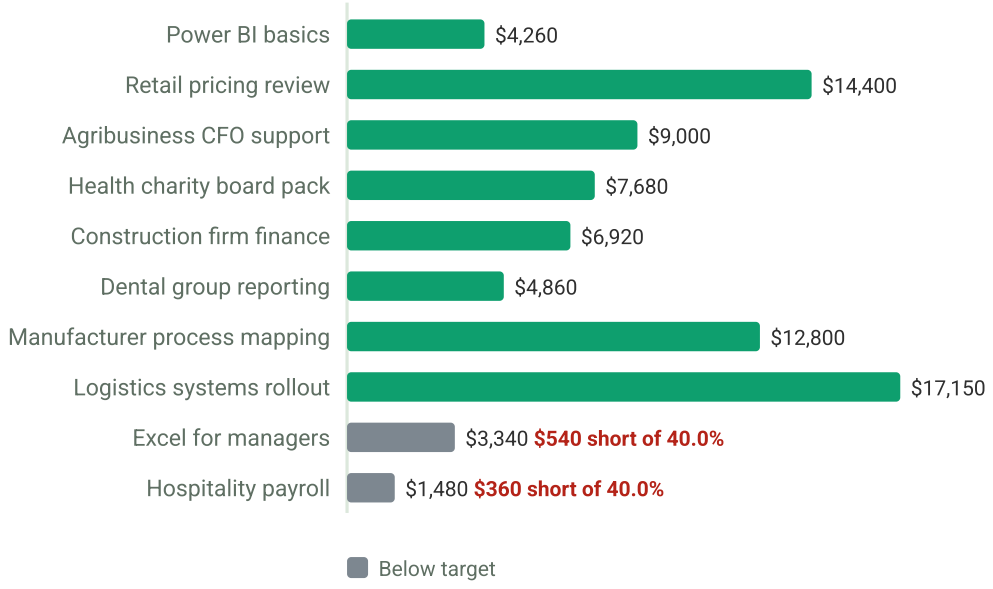
Gross margin on each client engagement, September 2026 work only

September's revenue less contractors and consultant time at $60/hour. Before overheads: not profit. Not the whole engagement to date. One 40.0% target for every engagement for now.

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



How each number is worked out

Consultant utilisation

Billable hours ÷ hours available

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Billable hours (timesheets)	764.0 h	662.0 h
Consultants	6	6
Working days	22	20
Hours per day	7.6 h	7.6 h
Hours available	1,003.2 h	912.0 h
Utilisation	**76.2%**	**72.6%**

Revenue per billable hour

Revenue ÷ billable hours

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Revenue	$145,330	$126,500
Billable hours	764.0 h	662.0 h
Revenue per hour	**$190**	**$191**

Retainers and training are fixed fees, so fewer hours on them raises the hourly figure.

Cash tied up in work

Work in progress + unpaid invoices at month end

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Work in progress (project time not yet billed)	$109,810	$86,000
Unpaid client invoices	$141,592	$86,405
Total tied up	**$251,402**	**$172,405**

Milestone billing on the logistics and manufacturer projects landed at the end of September, so it moved from unbilled to unpaid.

Client engagements, September 2026

Engagement	Type	Hours	Revenue	Billed	Contractors	Gross margin	Gross margin %
Agribusiness CFO support	Retainer	70	13,200	13,200	-	9,000	68.2
Construction firm finance	Retainer	58	10,400	10,400	-	6,920	66.5
Dental group reporting	Retainer	44	7,500	7,500	-	4,860	64.8
Excel for managers	Training	36	9,700	9,700	4,200	3,340	34.4
Health charity board pack	Project	64	11,520	11,520	-	7,680	66.7
Hospitality payroll	Retainer	52	4,600	4,600	-	1,480	32.2
Logistics systems rollout	Project	210	40,950	33,400	11,200	17,150	41.9
Manufacturer process mapping	Project	120	22,200	26,100	2,200	12,800	57.7
Power BI basics	Training	14	5,100	5,100	-	4,260	83.5
Retail pricing review	Project	96	20,160	-	-	14,400	71.4

Profit and loss, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Revenue			
Projects (hours worked)	94,830	83,800	11,030
Retainers	35,700	35,700	-
Training	14,800	7,000	7,800
Total revenue	**145,330**	**126,500**	**18,830**
Cost of sales			
Consultant salaries (incl. on-costs)	(60,192)	(54,720)	(5,472)
Contractors	(17,600)	(6,900)	(10,700)
Total cost of sales	**(77,792)**	**(61,620)**	**(16,172)**
Gross profit	**67,538**	**64,880**	**2,658**
Operating expenses			
Management and admin wages	(24,000)	(24,000)	-
Marketing and business development	(5,800)	(6,500)	700
Rent and occupancy	(8,000)	(8,000)	-
IT and software	(4,500)	(4,500)	-
Professional indemnity insurance	(2,500)	(2,500)	-
Travel	(1,800)	(2,600)	800
Other overheads	(3,300)	(3,300)	-
Total operating expenses	**(49,900)**	**(51,400)**	**1,500**
EBITDA	**17,638**	**13,480**	**4,158**
Depreciation	**(2,000)**	**(2,000)**	**-**
Interest	**(240)**	**(250)**	**10**
Profit before tax	**15,398**	**11,230**	**4,168**
Income tax provision (25%)	**(3,850)**	**(2,808)**	**(1,042)**
Net profit after tax	**11,548**	**8,422**	**3,126**

Balance sheet at 30 September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Current assets			
Cash at bank	207,781	229,278	(21,497)
Trade debtors (unpaid invoices)	141,592	86,405	55,187
Work in progress (unbilled project time)	109,810	86,000	23,810
Prepayments	15,000	15,000	-
Total current assets	**474,183**	**416,683**	**57,500**
Office equipment	**60,200**	**59,000**	**1,200**
Total assets	**534,383**	**475,683**	**58,700**
Current liabilities			
Trade creditors (bills due next month)	19,360	7,590	11,770
Wages owed (since the last pay run)	31,400	23,174	8,226
Super payable	3,766	2,780	986
PAYG withholding payable	47,814	31,876	15,938
GST payable (net)	20,412	12,930	7,482
Employee leave provisions	122,300	121,700	600
Income tax payable	55,158	51,308	3,850
Total current liabilities	**300,210**	**251,358**	**48,852**
Equipment finance	**14,600**	**16,300**	**(1,700)**
Total liabilities	**314,810**	**267,658**	**47,152**
Net assets	**219,573**	**208,025**	**11,548**
Equity			
Share capital	20,000	20,000	-
Retained earnings	199,573	188,025	11,548
Total equity	**219,573**	**208,025**	**11,548**

Cash flow, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked

$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Operating activities			
Receipts from customers (invoices paid)	78,485	166,100	(87,615)
Payments to contractors and suppliers	(36,080)	(34,430)	(1,650)
Payments to employees	(58,442)	(58,442)	-
Interest paid	(240)	(250)	10
GST, PAYG and income tax paid (BAS)	-	-	-
Net cash from operating activities	**(16,277)**	**72,978**	**(89,255)**
Investing activities			
Purchase of equipment	(3,520)	-	(3,520)
Net cash from investing activities	**(3,520)**	**-**	**(3,520)**
Financing activities			
Equipment finance repaid	(1,700)	(1,700)	-
Net cash from financing activities	**(1,700)**	**(1,700)**	**-**
Net change in cash	**(21,497)**	**71,278**	**(92,775)**
Cash at start of month	**229,278**	**158,000**	**71,278**
Cash at end of month	**207,781**	**229,278**	**(21,497)**

Assumptions

The business

What it is	A Brisbane finance and operations consultancy: projects billed on milestones, monthly retainers and training. 6 consultants, 3 management and admin staff.
Reporting month	September 2026, compared with August 2026
Financial year	FY2027: 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

Engagements (September)

Projects	hours worked at each project's rate; billed on milestones (unbilled time = work in progress)
Retainers	fixed monthly fee, billed monthly
Training	fixed fee, billed on delivery
Engagements in September	10 (every one is in the spreadsheet download and CSV)

Costs

Consultants	6 employed full time: $60,192 in September incl. on-costs (every available hour at $60)
Engagement costing rate	$60/hour = consultant salaries incl. on-costs ÷ available hours, worked out each month; time charged to clients + time not charged = salaries
Working days	20 in August (21 weekdays, less the Ekka People's Day holiday, Wed 12 Aug), 22 in September; 7.6 hours a day
Income tax	25% of profit, provided monthly

Cash and balance sheet

Client payments	each invoice is paid on its own date; unpaid invoices at month end = debtors
Contractors	paid the following month

GST, BAS and payroll

GST	registered; 10%, accruals basis: GST on a sale is owed when it's invoiced, a credit on a bill is claimed when it's received. The P&L excludes GST; invoices, bills, debtors, creditors and cash include it
BAS	quarterly, self-lodged: GST on sales − GST credits + PAYG withheld + PAYG instalment. July to September is due 28 October; October to December, 28 February
Pay runs	fortnightly on Thursdays: $33,205 gross (a 26th of the year's gross wages); net pay $25,236 and super $3,985 paid on the day; PAYG withheld (about 24% of gross, $7,969) goes with the BAS. Two months a year have three pay runs
Super	12% of gross wages, paid with each pay run (Payday Super, from 1 July 2026)
Payroll tax	none: Queensland's threshold is $1.3 million of wages a year (rate 4.75% above it); this business pays about $967,000 including super
Banking days	money only moves on banking days: a payment due on a weekend or Queensland public holiday moves to the next banking day

Checks (all passed)

- ✓ Every subtotal and total adds up
- ✓ Balance sheet balances: assets = liabilities + equity
- ✓ Cash flow ends at the cash in the bank
- ✓ Profit ties to the movement in retained earnings
- ✓ Every engagement's revenue adds up to the P&L
- ✓ Work in progress equals unbilled project time; debtors equal unpaid invoices

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